03 | EISENHOWER CHART | RESOURCE

Using the Eisenhower Chart

How to set priorities based on your actual duties and authority

Urgency is about time: what happens if a task is delayed. Importance is about results: required work, services, safety, and agreed goals. A request can feel urgent and still not be the best use of your time.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** There is a real deadline or risk to services. Act now, using the correct approval process.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Set aside time for planning, prevention, training, and required work before it becomes urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Confirm the request is real. Then route it, delegate it, or ask for more time, if you have the authority.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** If the work is not required and serves no purpose, cut it back or stop it.

Your role defines what is important

Start with your job duties, your branch RACI, current procedures, and your supervisor's expectations. A request from someone senior still needs to be checked against the actual service need and deadline.

Office Hours and focus time

When it makes sense, save non-urgent questions for the published Office Hours or support schedule. Use protected focus time to finish important work, process requests, and answer messages. Urgent service or safety issues should go through the required process right away, without waiting for Office Hours.

> **Two common mistakes**
> Q3 does not mean handing every urgent task to someone else. Q4 does not mean dropping a required duty. Before you change or stop any work, check whether it is needed and whether you have the authority.

Source: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.

Learn more: FranklinCovey: urgency and importance

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Eisenhower Chart Examples and Planner

These are made-up examples. Your own facts and role may put a task in a different quadrant.

Example	Quadrant	Next step
Coverage is missing before the next required service window.	Q1	Use the correct process to cover the immediate service risk.
A clearer job aid would prevent the same questions from coming up again.	Q2	Schedule time to write the update and get any required review.
Someone wants an optional font change by noon. It does not affect the work.	Q3	Confirm the deadline and the reason. Ask for more time or reroute it, if you have the authority.
Someone is still polishing an optional flyer for an event that was canceled.	Q4	Confirm nothing still requires it, then stop or cut back the work.

Plan one important task

Use this space	Your notes
Task and why it matters	
Deadline / time set aside	
Quadrant, next step, owner	
What "done" looks like	

Review how it went

Did you use the time you set aside? What got in the way? Did the work cut down on repeat questions, reduce rework, or improve service? Adjust your plan as needed.

> **Write down your next step**
> "I will finish _____ during _____. The result will be _____. I need _____ to confirm _____."

Source: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.